Roads (Royal and Otherwise) of J-pop

2026 NECMT - Supplemental Material

For inquiries and/or a Gdoc of complete, intermittently updating list of song examples arranged by schema, please email me at qi.brandon@gmail.com

I. List of Common J-pop Schemata

Schema	Example
"Royal Road" (王道進行, *ōdō shinkō*)	F(△7) – G(7) – Em(7) – Am(7)
"Twist Royal Road"	F(△7) – G(7) – Am(7) – Em(7) **or** C/E
"Hopscotch"	F – G – Am – C
"Marusa" (マルサ)	F(△7) – E(7) – Am(7) – (Gm7) – C(7)
"Komuro" (小室進行)	Am – F – G – C
Axis Progressions	Rotations of F – C – G – Am
"Mario Cadence"/"Aeolian Cadence"	F(△7) – G(7) – A or Ab(△7) – Bb(7) – C

II. Lyrics (In order of appearance):

ClariS 2012 - "Connect" (*Puella Magi Madoka Magica* - op)

First Chorus

To draw the future when my awakened heart has run away, Even if I stop on the difficult road The sky will always remain its beautiful blue, Whatever happens from now on, I won't be discouraged	目覚めた心は走り出した未来を描くため 難しい道で立ち止まっても 空は綺麗な青さでいつも待っててくれる だから怖くない もう何があっても挫けない

Yuming (Arai Yumi) 1975 - "Graduation Photograph 卒業写真"

First Chorus

When I go with the flow, please scold the changing me sometimes from far away	人ごみに流されて 変わってゆく私を あなたはときどき 遠くでしっかて

PinocchioP 2022 - "Reincarnation Apple 転生林檎" ft. Hatsune Miku

First Chorus

(Official English Translation)

Again and again, reborn and reborn Dancing on a mountain of corpses Reincarnation, grievous cry of reincarnation Love me, love me, no Again and again, reborn and reborn The same characterless stories are sparkling Reincarnation, overkill at the end of endless reincarnations Why, oh why	くりかえし　くりかえし　生まれ変わり 山積みの亡骸の上でダンシング リインカーネーション　リインカーネーションの悲痛な叫び 愛して　愛して　嫌 くりかえし　くりかえし　生まれ変わり きらめく似たり寄ったりのストーリー リインカーネーション　リインカーネーションの果てのオーバーキル どうして　どうして

Sheena Ringo 1999 - "Marunouchi Sadistic 丸の内サディスティック"

First Chorus

The smell of my Marshall gets me so high it's dangerous Every night it it brings me over the edge A single RAT is the only tool I need When Benji's music gets in my lungs, I trip	マーシャルの匂いで飛んじゃって大変さ 毎晩絶頂に達して居るだけ ラット1つを商売道具にしているさ そしたらベンジーが肺に映ってトリップ

YOASOBI 2019 - “Racing into the Night 夜に駆ける**”**

(Official English Translation)

[Intro] Just like I'm about to sink, just like I'm about to melt Only the two of us at night in the vast sky	[Intro] 沈むように溶けてゆくように 二人だけの空が広がる夜に
[Verse] It was only a simple goodbye But it was all I needed to understand The sinkingsun,therising night sky Overlapswith your figurebehind the fence Ever since the day we first met You stole my heart Like you were wrapped in fragile air You had a lonely gaze	[Verse] 「さよなら」だけだった その一言で全てが分かった 日が沈み出した空と君の姿 フェンス越しに重なっていた 初めて会った日から 僕の心の全てを奪った どこか儚い空気を纏う君は 寂しい目をしてたんだ
[Prechorus] In the world always ringing with "tick-tocks," again and again Touching the heartless words and loud voices Even if tears are about to spill If it were the two of us together I'm sure mundane happiness could be found	[Prechorus] いつだってチックタックと 鳴る世界で何度だってさ 触れる心無い言葉うるさい声に 涙が零れそうでも ありきたりな喜びきっと二人なら見つけられる
[Chorus] In the troubling days, for the never-smiling you I give my utmost love in hopes for the dazzling tomorrow In the never ending night before we fall Come and take my hand Even the days that you hid inside, wanting to forget It'll melt with the warmth of my embraces No need to be afraid, until dawn comes someday Let's be together	[Chorus] 騒がしい日々に笑えない君に 思い付く限り眩しい明日を 明けない夜に落ちてゆく前に 僕の手を掴んでほら 忘れてしまいたくて閉じ込めた日々も 抱きしめた温もりで溶かすから 怖くないよいつか日が昇るまで 二人でいよう

III. Selection of recent J-pop/Mandopop with IV endings

Song	Year	Artist	Details
“SAKURA”	2007	Ikimonogatari いきものがかり	IV - ii - iii - IV - III^{6} - **IV**
“Meltdown” 炉心融解	2011	Iroha(sasaki) Ft. Rin	vi - IV - III vi - IV - III - **IV**
“Colorful”	2013	ClariS	IV - V - iii - vi IV - V - **IV**
“Last flower” 最後の花	2016	40mP ft. Miku	IV - V^{2} - iii - vi ii - V - **IV**
“*Nandemonaiya*” なんでもないや	2016	RADWIMPS	IV - V - **IV**
“April Showers”	2019	Aimer	IV - V - III - vi ii - iii - IV - V - **IV**
“Lilac” ライラック	2019	Minami 美波	IV - V - vi - iii - **IV**
“i'm getting on the bus to the other world, see ya!” あの世行きのバスに乗ってさらば	2020	TUYU	IV - V - iii - vi - ii - V - **IV**
“Lemon”	2020	Kenshi Yonezu 米津玄師	IV - I - III - vi ii - vi - IV - V - #iv^{o} ii - vi - IV - V - I

Song	Year	Artist	Details
			ii - vi - IV - V - **IV**
“*Aitakute*” 会いたくて	2021	Ado	vi - **IV**
“As you don’t know” 知らないままで	2022	Rokudenashi ロクデナシ	vi - IV - V - I **IV**
“Tower of Flower” 花の塔	2022	Sayuri	IV - I - V - vi IV - I - V - **IV**
“Guitar, Loneliness and Blue Planet” ギターと孤独と蒼い惑星	2022	Kesssoku band 結束バンド	IV - V - vi vi - V - I - V vi **- IV**
“KokoroToluNaNoFukakai” 心という名の不可解	2022	Ado	IV - V - vi **IV**
“Dialogue Between Light and Shadow” 光与影的对白	2022	COPY ft. Luo Tian Yi 洛天依	IV - V - iii - vi IV - V - **IV**
“Love Rush”	2023	Takanashi Kiara	IV - V - iii - vi IV - iii - vi - ii - V - **IV**
“*tada koe hitotsu*” ただ声一つ	2023	Rokudenashi ロクデナシ	vi - IV - V - I **IV**
“Where Our Blue Is” 青のすみか	2024	Tatsuya Kitani キタニタツヤ	IV - V - vi - iii IV - V - vi - I

Song	Year	Artist	Details
			IV
“Sakura Biyori and Time Machine” 桜日和とタイムマシン	2024	Ado w/ Miku	I - IV - V - III - vi - #iv^{o} - V **IV**
“Melt CPK! remix”	2026	Ryo ft. Miku	This one is interesting because the remix heavily emphasizes a IV-vi complex only hinted at in the original

IV. Bibliography

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